

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | Detection Engineering | KQL | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified security engineer with over five years of in-house enterprise security operations experience, with strong specialisation in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection development, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook automation. I have designed and maintained enterprise-wide log onboarding pipelines, built custom detection content aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and delivered SIEM solutions covering Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon, and broader cloud security telemetry. I combine deep hands-on technical engineering ability with experience leading threat hunting investigations and post-incident root cause analysis. I am well suited to a Microsoft-centric managed security partner environment where Sentinel engineering, detection content quality, and customer-facing investigation capability are central to the role.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Enterprise SIEM deployment, custom connector development, log onboarding, Function Apps and parsers, KQL analytics rules, workbooks, hunting queries, SOAR playbook automation (Logic Apps)
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; alert investigation, advanced hunting with KQL, cross-product correlation
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content; use case development; alert tuning; threat-led detection design; incident correlation across SIEM and XDR telemetry
- **SOAR and Automation:** SOAR playbook design; automated enrichment, triage, and containment workflows; PowerShell scripting for security automation
- **EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover, Spotlight); endpoint detection, policy management, threat intelligence integration
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multifactor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security posture; Defender for Cloud; cloud workload protection
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 -- Present*

- Own and operate the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment for an 8,000-user enterprise; manage log ingestion pipelines, connector configurations, and data transformation to ensure complete telemetry coverage across endpoints, identity, email, and cloud workloads.
- Write and maintain KQL analytics rules, hunting queries, and custom workbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK; continuously tune detection content to reduce false positive rates while maintaining high-fidelity alerting.
- Design and develop SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps) within Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment, threat intelligence lookups, containment actions, and analyst notification workflows.
- Conduct threat hunting investigations across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM using advanced KQL and CrowdStrike query language; investigate nation-state aligned TTPs (Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures) and advanced persistent threat (APT) indicators.

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the enterprise estate; lead cross-product alert correlation within Microsoft 365 Defender.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover); integrate CrowdStrike telemetry into Sentinel via API connectors for unified detection and response.
- Lead end-to-end incident response under NIST 800-61; produce post-incident reports with detailed root cause analysis, control gap identification, and remediation recommendations.
- Manage Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, and identity lifecycle controls; administer BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account governance.
- Oversee vulnerability scanning programmes using Tenable.io and Pentra BAS; track remediation progress and report risk reduction metrics to senior leadership.
- Maintain Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001-aligned control evidence; contribute to continuous service improvement across the security operations function.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Administered Microsoft Sentinel day-to-day operations including connector health monitoring, log source onboarding (Windows, Linux, Mimecast, network appliances), and alert rule management.
- Developed KQL queries for threat hunting, scheduled detection rules, and dashboard workbooks to support security operations centre (SOC) visibility and reporting.
- Built and maintained SOAR automation playbooks to streamline phishing triage, account lockout workflows, and endpoint isolation responses.
- Monitored and investigated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and CrowdStrike Falcon alerts; escalated confirmed threats to the incident response process with documented evidence chains.
- Managed Entra ID (Azure AD) identity controls including Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) role assignments.
- Supported penetration test remediation by mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK and developing corresponding Sentinel detection rules to improve coverage.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning with Nessus and Tenable.io; collaborated with infrastructure teams to prioritise and remediate findings against CIS Controls benchmarks.
- Authored and maintained SOC Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), incident response runbooks, and SIEM use case documentation.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce end-user risk exposure.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Configured and maintained endpoint detection and network security controls across SaaS production and corporate environments, including SIEM log forwarding and alert baseline establishment.
- Administered identity and access management controls including SSO, MFA, and role-based access control (RBAC) across cloud-hosted applications.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments and supported remediation tracking aligned to ISO 27001 risk management practices.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for patch management, access control reporting, and security telemetry collection.
- Supported internal audit preparation and ISO 27001 compliance evidence gathering for the information security management system (ISMS).

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive detection content library in Microsoft Sentinel covering 40+ MITRE ATT&CK techniques across identity, endpoint, email, and cloud domains, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) by approximately 40%.
- Onboarded and normalised log sources from CrowdStrike Falcon, Mimecast, Entra ID, MDE, MDI, Tenable.io, and network devices into Microsoft Sentinel, achieving full telemetry coverage across the 8,000-user estate.

- Designed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced analyst handling time on repetitive alert types by approximately 60% through automated enrichment, triage, and containment.
- Led a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercise that identified 30+ previously unknown attack paths; developed corresponding Sentinel detection rules to close each identified gap.
- Delivered a CISSP-certified-led review of the SIEM architecture that identified and remediated six critical gaps in log coverage, including previously unseen lateral movement indicators.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation for UAL by mapping SIEM and detection controls to certification requirements and producing auditable evidence across all in-scope systems.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)